

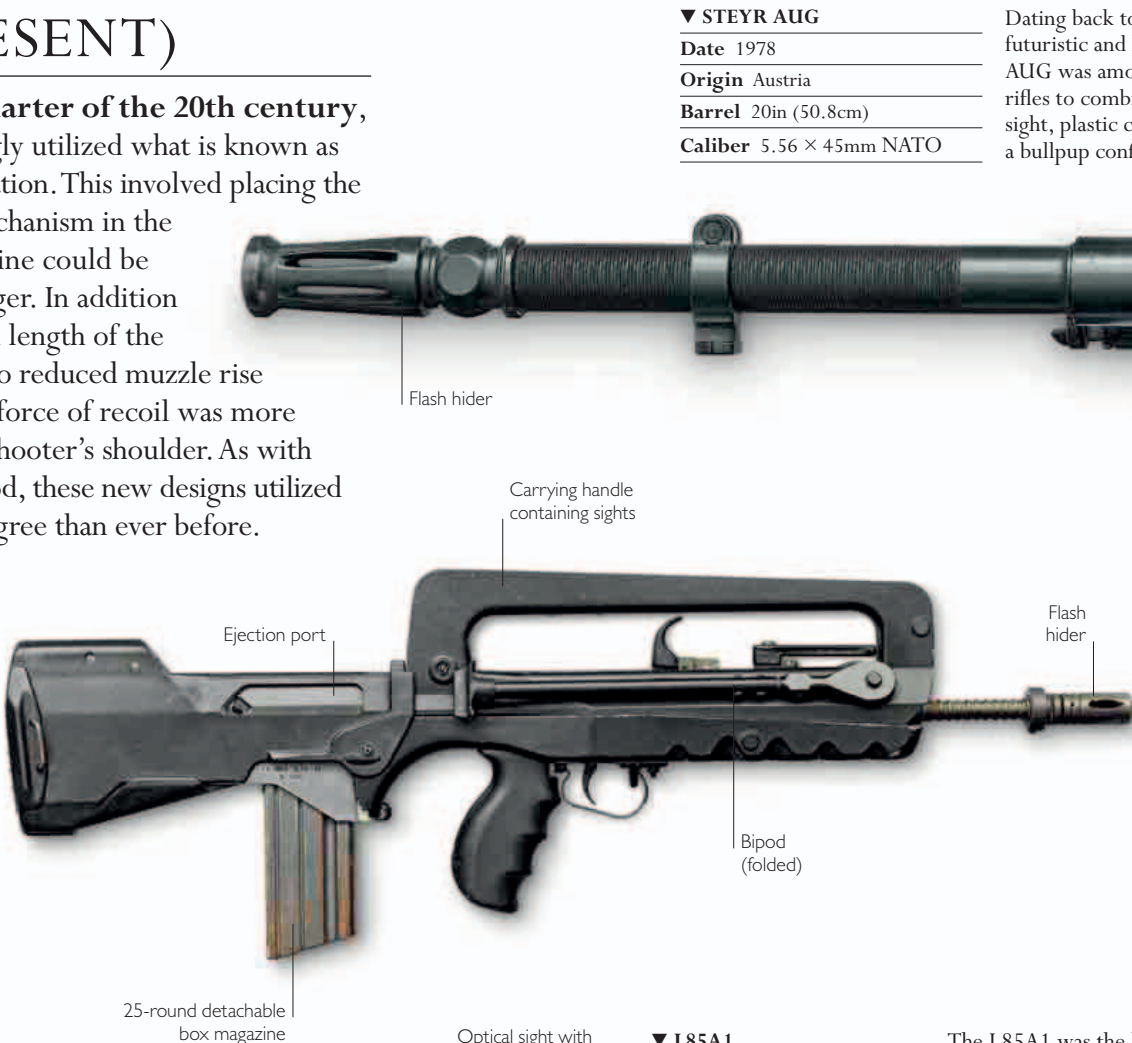
ASSAULT RIFLES (1976–PRESENT)

During the final quarter of the 20th century, assault rifles increasingly utilized what is known as the “bullpup” configuration. This involved placing the bolt and the recoil mechanism in the butt so that the magazine could be placed behind the trigger. In addition to reducing the overall length of the firearm, this design also reduced muzzle rise considerably since the force of recoil was more fully absorbed by the shooter’s shoulder. As with other arms of the period, these new designs utilized plastics to a greater degree than ever before.

► **FAMAS F1**

Date	1978
Origin	France
Barrel	19¼in (48.8cm)
Caliber	5.56 × 45mm NATO

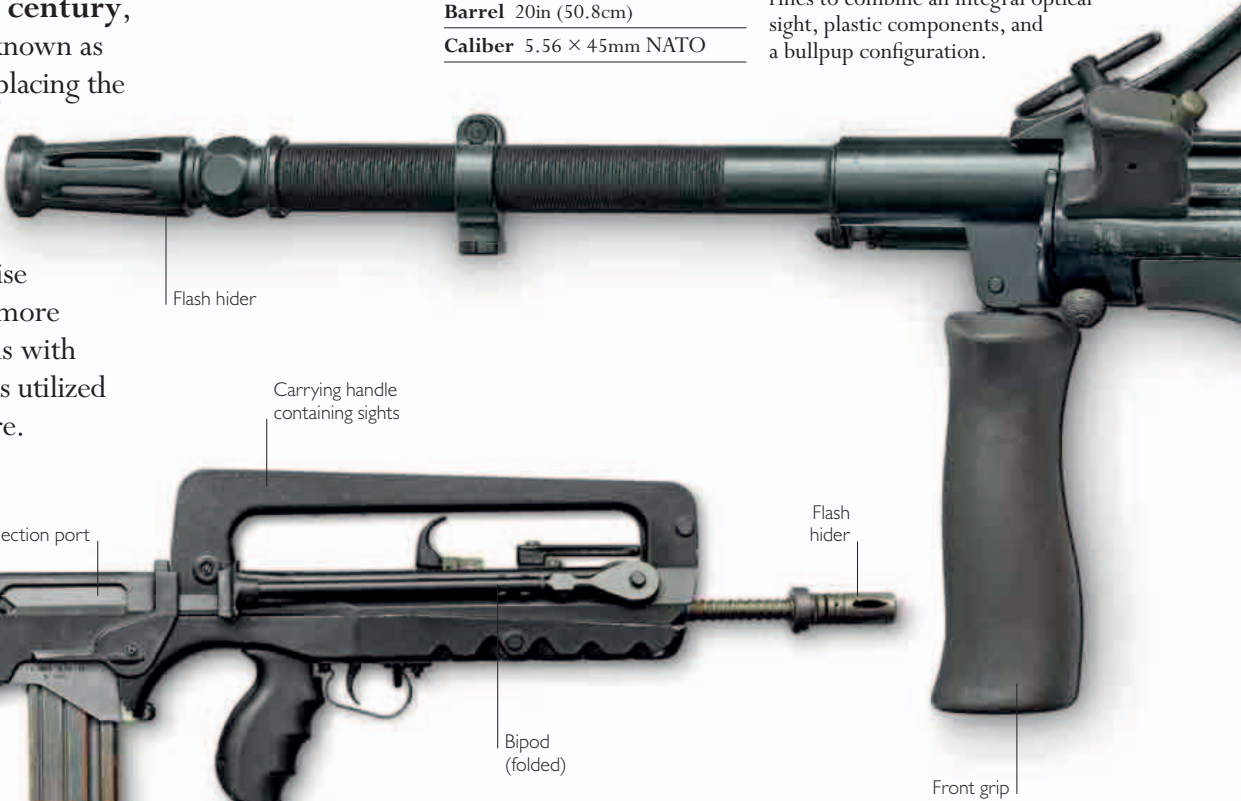
A bullpup design, the FAMAS F1 is a very compact weapon and has been used by the French armed forces since the late 1970s. Like many modern assault rifles, it makes use of plastics and stamped metal components.



▼ **STEYR AUG**

Date	1978
Origin	Austria
Barrel	20in (50.8cm)
Caliber	5.56 × 45mm NATO

Dating back to the 1970s, the futuristic and highly successful AUG was among the first assault rifles to combine an integral optical sight, plastic components, and a bullpup configuration.



▼ **L85A1**

Date	1985
Origin	UK
Barrel	20½in (51.8cm)
Caliber	5.56 × 45mm NATO

The L85A1 was the last weapon system to be developed and produced at the Royal Small Arms Factory, Enfield, UK, before it closed in 1988. It was dogged with problems during the development stage, and trials continued even after its adoption in 1985. It was designed from the start to use an optical sight. The body and many other parts are steel stampings. All the furniture is high-impact plastic.

